

ESSENTIAL

Financial Requirements Overview

Means of subsistence - reference amounts vary by which consulate you apply to

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

Reference amounts vary by member state

Unlike a single EU-wide figure, each Schengen member state publishes its own reference amount for “sufficient means of subsistence” per day (or a flat amount for the whole stay), and the exact figure changes over time. Confirm the current reference amount for the specific consulate you're applying to before relying on any number - it genuinely differs by destination country, not just over time.

What consulates generally look for

- Funds proportionate to your stated trip length, adjusted for whether accommodation is already paid
- Consistency with your stated income and travel plans
- If a third party is covering costs, their financial evidence plus a formal sponsorship declaration in the form required by that specific consulate

Acceptable evidence

- Bank statements covering a reasonable recent period, not a single-day snapshot
- Pay slips or an employer letter confirming income
- Savings, fixed deposits, or investment statements
- A sponsor's financial evidence plus their formal sponsorship/invitation declaration, if someone else is funding the trip

Red flags

- A large, recent, unexplained deposit shortly before applying
- A balance inconsistent with the applicant's stated occupation or income

— Financial evidence that doesn't clearly cover the insurance and accommodation costs you've also declared